

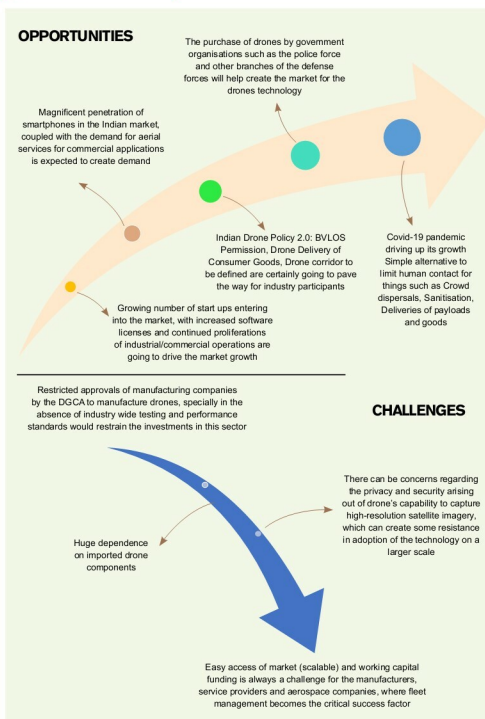


Fig. 4: Opportunities and challenges

Government is all set to create the market demand through the introduction of UAS Policy 2.0 accompanied with a series of measures

The intent of the Indian government is clear from its series of steps taken in the recent time to generate interest among the stakeholders and the influencers in the UAV industry. Ministry of Civil Aviation has released the draft UAS Rules (Unmanned Aircraft System) 2020 for public feedback on 4 Jun 2020. Subsequently, another draft CAR for drone training was released for public feedback on 14 Jun 2020. UAS Traffic Management (UTM) policy too is on the way, which will be expected to pave the way for a safe and scalable traffic management in tandem with the ATC (Air Traffic Management). Also, around 20,600 Drone Acknowledgment Numbers (DAN) were allotted by 30 Jun 2020.

The Ministry is opening doors for power and infrastructure sector to start using drones for the use cases such as powerline and pipeline inspections. GARUD ('Government Authorisation for Relief Using Drones') portal has been launched to offer fast track approvals to the government agencies across the key sectors including infrastructure, agriculture, healthcare, defence and national security for the incorporation of drones in their operations such as aerial surveillance, aerial photography and public announcements. Ministry of Agriculture, Survey of India, Maharashtra Transco, Indian Oil, state governments have already got the approval for drone operations. Maharashtra Transco happens to be the first power utility company to get the DGCA approval for powerline inspection using drones.

Such initiatives are bound to create the market and business opportunity for drone entrepreneurs.

The government is also bringing efficiency in awarding the contracts to the industries through purely online applications. Around nine training schools were provided license to train drone pilots, an endeavour towards building a sustainable ecosystem of operations.

SVAMITVA (Survey of villages and mapping with improvised tech-

Green Zones Approved and Activated by the MoCA for Drone Flights

The sites are circles with 5km radius

Each green zone is 78.5 sq km in area with their centre points at:

15°30'15.5"N 78°29'29.5"E (Nandyal, Andhra Pradesh)

13°39'56.1"N 77°20'36.2"E (Tumkur, Karnataka)

18°18'18.0"N 73°11'19.0"E (Sonsade, Maharashtra)

27°59'26.8"N 76°23'04.2"E (Neemrana, Rajasthan)

12°42'55.0"N 79°16'45.9"E (Arani, Tamilnadu)

22°41'49.5"N 87°35'03.5"E (Kharsa, West Bengal)

Source Ministry of Civil Aviation